Mindful Work App – 7 UX Personas for a Design Thinking project on stress-free offices

DESIGN THINKING PROJECT · USER RESEARCH

Mindful Work App — Persona Profiles

Designing a Stress-Free Office Experience · 7 Personas

RY

IT / TECH · OFFICE

The Overloaded Tech Professional

Riya · Age 23–30 · Software / IT Role Office

Stress level ●●●● 4 / 5

"I have too much to finish in less time — my afternoons feel impossible."

GOALS

- Complete tasks efficiently without burning out by end of day
- Build consistent, effective break habits during afternoon hours
- Monitor stress patterns to stay in control of workload

FRUSTRATIONS

- Breaks are irregular and rarely feel refreshing
- Screen fatigue compounds deadline anxiety in the afternoons
- No structured system to cue rest or detect stress build-up

NEEDS

- AI mood detection to flag stress before it peaks
- Curated music playlists for focus and decompression
- Quiet dim-light break environment prompts and scheduling

Triggers: Deadlines · Overload · Screen fatigue Peak: Afternoon Mood: Anxious · Overwhelmed

AI: Open to it

AV

MANAGEMENT · OFFICE

The Perfectionist Manager

Aarav · Age 31–40 · Senior Manager Office

Stress level ●●●●● 5 / 5

"I need everything to go perfectly — there's no room to pause and breathe."

GOALS

FRUSTRATIONS

NEEDS

- Carve out structured relaxation time despite a packed morning schedule
- Use meditation to reduce anxiety before high-stakes meetings
- Track emotional state to manage performance pressure proactively

- Back-to-back meetings leave zero time for mental recovery
- Deadline pressure spills into personal time, worsening anxiety
- No easy way to book or schedule a guided wellness session

- Guided meditation sessions bookable within the app
- Mood detection to suggest micro-breaks between meetings
- Silent, distraction-free environment mode during sessions

Triggers: Meetings · Deadlines Peak: Morning Mood: Frustrated · Anxious AI: Considering

PR

INTERN · HYBRID

The Distracted Intern

Priya · Age 18–22 · Intern Hybrid

Stress level ●●● 3 / 5

"I feel exhausted and distracted — my evenings blur into mindless phone scrolling."

GOALS

- Establish healthy break routines to recover energy by evening
- Replace mindless phone use with intentional relaxation
- Find simple, engaging ways to decompress after hybrid workdays

FRUSTRATIONS

- Phone acts as a distraction rather than a recovery tool
- Work overload without scheduled breaks leads to evening fatigue
- Existing coping methods (phone, music) feel ineffective (score 2/5)

NEEDS

- Visual + audio relaxation content (nature sounds, ambient visuals)
- Guided break prompts to redirect attention away from social media
- Lightweight, mobile-friendly interface for hybrid use

Triggers: Overload · Lack of breaks Peak: Evening Mood: Tired · Unmotivated AI: Open to it

SM

MANAGEMENT · OFFICE

The Silently Overwhelmed Leader

Sameer · Age 40+ · Senior Manager Office

Stress level ●●●● 4 / 5

"There's too much responsibility — and no system to help me step back and recharge."

GOALS

FRUSTRATIONS

NEEDS

- Gain visibility into personal stress patterns via structured tracking
- Create moments of complete quiet to decompress during the afternoon
- Find a reliable system that replaces non-existent coping habits

- Has no current coping mechanism — stress goes entirely unmanaged
- Work overload and meetings pile up without any release valve
- Prefers privacy and silence — group wellness solutions feel intrusive

- Stress and workload tracking dashboard with simple visuals
- Completely silent break mode — no audio, no notifications
- Non-AI, privacy-first experience to build user trust

Triggers: Overload · Meetings Peak: Afternoon Mood: Overwhelmed · Frustrated AI: Not interested

AN

CREATIVE · WORK FROM HOME

The Late-Night Creative Burnout

Ananya · Age 23–30 · Creative Professional Work from Home

Stress level ●●● 3 / 5

"I can't focus anymore — the night blends into work and I can never fully disconnect."

GOALS

- Create a clear mental boundary between work time and rest time
- Use music and lighting cues to shift from creative mode to wind-down
- Track late-night stress spikes and receive timely nudges to pause

FRUSTRATIONS

- Work-from-home blurs the boundary between deadlines and downtime
- Screen fatigue accumulates unnoticed until focus collapses entirely
- Music and breaks help moderately but don't resolve disconnection

NEEDS

- AI mood detection with late-night break reminders
- Ambient music + soft lighting environment to signal end of work
- Focus session timers that enforce structured deep-work blocks

Triggers: Deadlines · Screen fatigue Peak: Late night Mood: Tired · Anxious AI: Open to it

RL

IT / TECH · HYBRID

The Pressure-Driven Developer

Rahul · Age 23–30 · Software / IT Role Hybrid

Stress level ●●●●● 5 / 5

"I'm constantly under pressure — my breaks do nothing and the noise makes it worse."

GOALS

- Replace ineffective social-media breaks with meaningful recovery
- Use guided breathing to quickly lower stress during evening peaks
- Visualise stress data on a dashboard to spot and prevent burnout

FRUSTRATIONS

- Breaks are taken but leave him feeling no better (score 2/5)
- Ambient noise at hybrid workspaces amplifies overwhelm
- Deadline and workload pressure creates a relentless stress loop

NEEDS

- Guided breathing exercise module with timers and visual cues
- Personalised stress dashboard with trends and recommendations
- AI-powered break prompts triggered by workload spikes

Triggers: Deadlines · Noise · Overload Peak: Evening Mood: Overwhelmed · Anxious AI: Open to it

NH

STUDENT · WORK FROM HOME

The Quietly Fatigued Starter

Neha · Age 18–22 · Student Work from Home

Stress level ●● 2 / 5

"I just need a small break — the tiredness is mild but it never really goes away."

GOALS

- Maintain steady energy through the evening with light, music-led breaks
- Prevent low-level fatigue from accumulating into a bigger problem
- Keep wellness habits simple, enjoyable, and low-effort

FRUSTRATIONS

- Consistent background tiredness with no clear cause or resolution
- Lack of scheduled breaks during long study and work-from-home hours
- Wellness tools feel overly complex for her low-intensity stress level

NEEDS

- Simple music-based relaxation feature with curated playlists
- Gentle break reminders at regular intervals during evening sessions
- Light, approachable UI with optional AI suggestions (non-intrusive)

Triggers: Lack of breaks Peak: Evening Mood: Tired AI: Considering